

CREATIVE WRITING WORKBOOK

For Kids Ages 8-12

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Every great writer started with one story.

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THE 5 STORY ELEMENTS

CHARACTER

The people (or animals/creatures) in your story. Who is it about?

SETTING

When and where your story takes place.

PLOT

What happens in your story - the events from start to finish.

CONFLICT

The problem or challenge your character faces.

RESOLUTION

How the problem gets solved at the end.

Every great story needs all 5! Let's practice each one.

CHARACTER CREATION - PAGE 1

What Does Your Character Look Like?

Character name: _____

Age: _____ Boy/Girl/Other: _____

Hair color & style: _____

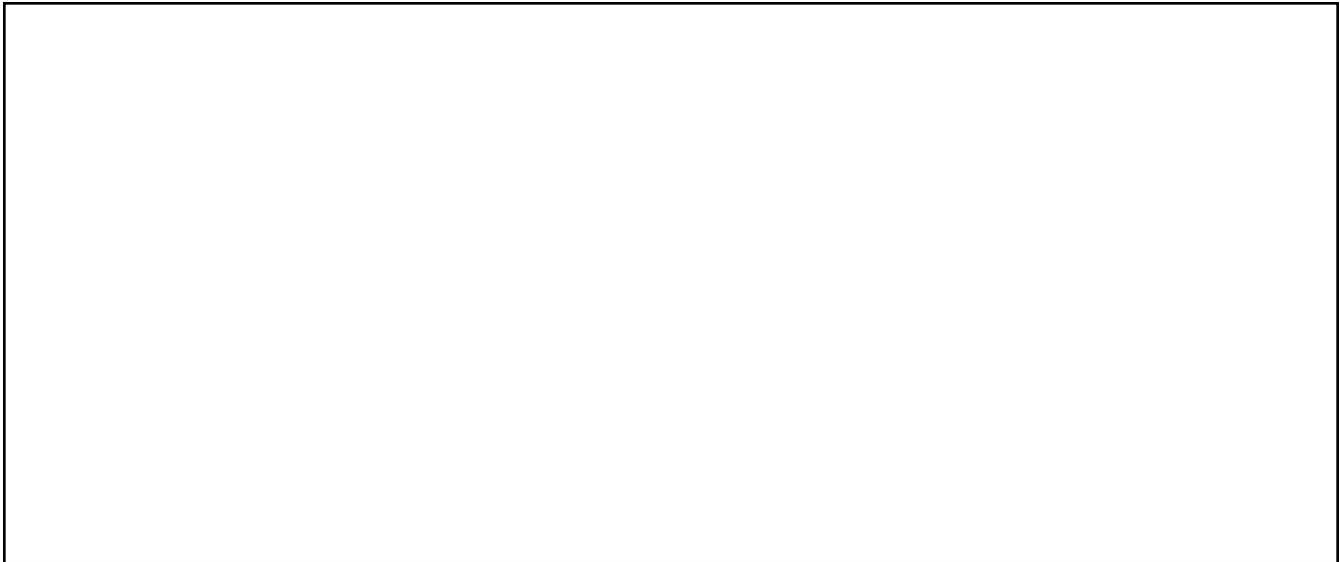
Eye color: _____

Height (tall/short/average): _____

What they usually wear: _____

Something unique about how they look: _____

Draw your character here:



CHARACTER CREATION - PAGE 2

Who Is Your Character Inside?

3 words that describe their personality:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

Their biggest strength: _____

Their biggest weakness: _____

Their favorite thing to do: _____

Their biggest fear: _____

What makes them laugh: _____

What makes them mad: _____

Their secret: _____

Their best friend is: _____

Their family: _____

CHARACTER CREATION - PAGE 3

What Does Your Character Want?

What do they want MORE than anything?

What is stopping them from getting it?

What would they do to get what they want?

How do they change by the end of the story?

SETTING BUILDER

Describe With 5 Senses!

My story takes place in: _____

Time period (past/present/future): _____

SEE: What does your character see? Colors, shapes, objects:

HEAR: What sounds are there? Loud? Quiet? Music? Animals?

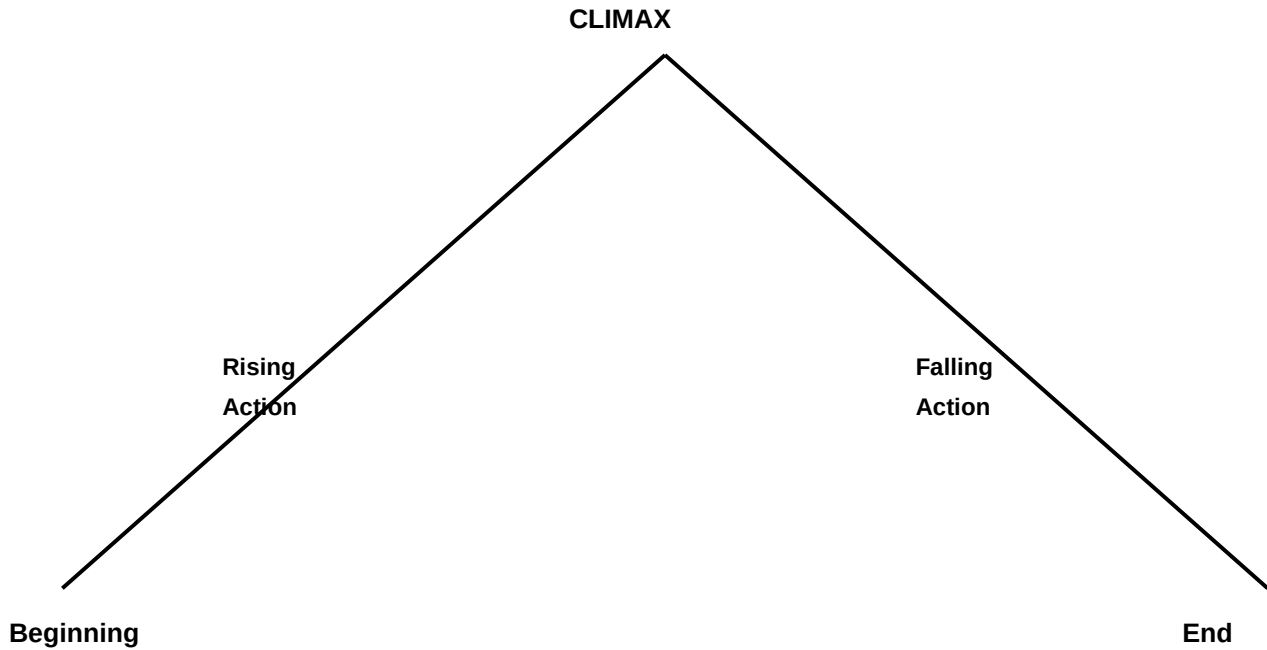
SMELL: What does it smell like? Fresh? Smoky? Sweet?

TOUCH: What do things feel like? Rough? Smooth? Hot? Cold?

TASTE: Any tastes? Food? Salty air? Dust?

PLOT MOUNTAIN

Every story follows a shape - like a mountain!



BEGINNING (introduce character + setting):

RISING ACTION (problems get bigger):

CLIMAX (biggest moment! Most exciting part!):

FALLING ACTION (things start to get better):

RESOLUTION (how it all ends):

STORY STARTER

The box had been buried in the backyard for 100 years...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

When I woke up, I could suddenly talk to animals...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

The map showed a place that shouldn't exist...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

My best friend has a secret that changed everything...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

The last day of school started with a loud BOOM...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

I found a door in my closet that wasn't there yesterday...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

The new kid at school was definitely not human...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

Three wishes. That's what the old woman offered me...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

The spaceship landed in our backyard on a Tuesday...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

I woke up and everyone in town had disappeared...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

The library book whispered my name when I walked past...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

My robot was supposed to do homework, but it had other plans...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

The storm brought something strange to our town...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

I discovered I could pause time, but only for 60 seconds...

Keep writing! What happens next?

STORY STARTER

The forgotten kingdom under the school cafeteria...

Keep writing! What happens next?

DIALOGUE PRACTICE - 1

RULES FOR WRITING DIALOGUE:

- Use quotation marks: "Hello!" she said.
- New speaker = new paragraph
- Use said, asked, whispered, shouted (not too fancy!)
- Show how they feel through actions too

PRACTICE: Two friends are arguing about what to do after school:

Lined area for writing the dialogue practice.

DIALOGUE PRACTICE - 2

PRACTICE: A kid is trying to convince a parent to get a pet:

DIALOGUE PRACTICE - 3

SHOW, DON'T TELL!

Instead of TELLING the reader how someone feels,
SHOW it through actions, body language, and details!

TELLING: She was scared.

SHOWING: Her hands shook. She pressed her back against the wall.

TELLING: He was angry.

SHOWING: He slammed his fist on the table and his face turned red.

TELLING: It was cold.

SHOWING: She pulled her jacket tighter, watching her breath form clouds.

YOUR TURN! Rewrite these by SHOWING:

Telling: The dog was happy.

Showing: _____

Telling: She was sad.

Showing: _____

Telling: The room was messy.

Showing: _____

Telling: He was excited.

Showing: _____

POETRY FUN!

HAIKU (3 lines: 5 syllables / 7 syllables / 5 syllables):

Example: An old silent pond (5) / A frog jumps into the pond (7) / Splash! Silence again (5)

Your haiku:

ACROSTIC (first letter of each line spells a word):

Write an acrostic for your name or favorite word:

LIMERICK (AABBA rhyme, funny & bouncy):

There once was a _____ from _____ (A)

Who _____ (A)

_____ (B)

_____ (B)

_____ (A)

EDITING CHECKLIST

Before you say 'I'm done!' check these:

- ☐ Does my story have a clear beginning, middle, and end?
- ☐ Did I describe my characters so readers can picture them?
- ☐ Did I use dialogue to make characters come alive?
- ☐ Did I SHOW feelings instead of just telling?
- ☐ Does my story have a problem that gets solved?
- ☐ Did I use interesting words (not just 'nice' and 'good')?
- ☐ Did I check for spelling mistakes?
- ☐ Did I use periods and capital letters correctly?
- ☐ Does each paragraph have one main idea?
- ☐ Would I want to read this story? Is it exciting?
- ☐ Did I read it out loud to catch awkward sentences?
- ☐ Did I give my story a great title?

ABOUT THE AUTHOR (THAT'S YOU!)

My pen name (or real name): _____

My age: _____

I love to write about: _____

My favorite book is: _____

My favorite author is: _____

When I grow up I want to: _____

Fun fact about me: _____

Write your author bio (the kind you see on book covers):

Draw yourself as an author:

